

# The remaining rules for the monster RPG maker

13 owner decisions across M4-M11 • effect algebra, mixing,  
progression, world authoring, and persistence

## PROPOSALS ONLY

Use the companion CSV to record A, B, or C for each group. A recommendation is highlighted, but no option becomes an engine rule until you approve it.

**HOW TO USE THIS PACKET**

# One choice closes one decision group

Read each group in order or jump to the milestones you want to unblock. Every option is a coherent package: selecting a letter approves the described behavior and constants together, except where the text explicitly reserves later balance tuning.

**FILL THE CSV**

Enter A, B, or C in Your\_Choice. Use Your\_Notes for changes such as “A, but use 50 Harmony growth.” Leave the proposal columns untouched so the response remains auditable.

**SCOPE**

This packet contains the 13 later gameplay, content, world, and persistence groups previously counted. The partially resolved D18 presentation-host work is tracked as implementation infrastructure and is outside this approval packet.

## Milestone map

| ID  | Gate                       | Decision group                                         | Rec.     |
|-----|----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| R01 | M4 Effect algebra          | Effect order, statuses, protection, and immunity       | <b>A</b> |
| R02 | M6 Mix runtime             | Mixed-source cooldown penalty                          | <b>A</b> |
| R03 | M6 Mix progression         | Harmony scale, growth, and battle benefits             | <b>A</b> |
| R04 | M5 Multi-type attacks      | Component allocation and rounding                      | <b>A</b> |
| R05 | M5 Multi-type attacks      | Same-type attack bonus for components                  | <b>A</b> |
| R06 | M6 Discovery and training  | Witnesses, training access, and outcome commits        | <b>A</b> |
| R07 | M7 Progression             | Level 1-200 XP, stats, and evolution                   | <b>A</b> |
| R08 | M7 Capture                 | Capture action, eligibility, and destination           | <b>A</b> |
| R09 | M7 Economy and roster      | Party, storage, move, inventory, and currency caps     | <b>A</b> |
| R10 | M8 Overworld               | World grid, movement, encounters, and conflicts        | <b>A</b> |
| R11 | M2 contracts / M10 Maker   | Catalog editing powers and engine authority            | <b>A</b> |
| R12 | M2 validation / M8 events  | Event graphs and cumulative content budgets            | <b>A</b> |
| R13 | M1 contracts / M11 release | Save, replay, migration, and battle-save compatibility | <b>A</b> |

## Recommended sequence

Approve R01 first to unblock M4. R04 and R05 then unblock multi-type attacks. R02, R03, and R06 close the mix system. R07–R09 define progression, capture, and capacities. R10–R12 close the overworld and maker safety boundary. R13 fixes the release compatibility contract.

DECISION 01 • R01 / D04 remainder • M4 Effect algebra

# Effect order, statuses, protection, and immunity

QUESTION

How should a move's ordered effects and named statuses combine when several rules touch the same target?

WHAT IT IS

This closes the combat rules that remain after the approved M3 damage kernel: effect ordering, status identity, reapplication, duration, protection, cleansing, and immunity.

EFFECT ON THE INITIAL IDEA

The original maker remains data driven: creators choose from a closed effect catalog, while the engine owns composition rules. This makes the editor predictable and keeps project data from embedding code.

WHAT IT DOES

It determines whether the same authored move always produces one transparent sequence of state changes, and whether a status refreshes, stacks, replaces, or fails.

DEPENDENCIES

Builds on approved sequential event resolution, atomic action commits, integer stages, and the M3 RNG draw policy. Gates representative status moves in M4.

## Options

### A | Closed ordered algebra RECOMMENDED

Resolve effects in authored declaration order inside one atomic action. A named status has one instance; reapplication refreshes duration and keeps the stronger magnitude. Explicitly incompatible statuses reject or replace according to an engine table. Protection and immunity are checked before affected effects.

Pros

- Easy to preview and explain
- No unbounded status pileups
- Stable replay and save semantics

Cons

- Less room for stack-heavy builds
- Engine must define each incompatibility

### B | Capped additive stacks

Resolve in declaration order, but allow repeated named statuses to add magnitude or stack count up to an engine cap; duration refreshes on each application.

Pros

- Supports combo-focused builds
- More granular status progression

Cons

- Harder UI and balance
- More state and edge cases
- Split attacks can exploit stacking

### C | Priority-normalized effects

Ignore authored order for conflicting categories. The engine sorts effects by global priority, and a newly applied status replaces the previous instance of the same family.

Pros

- Global behavior is uniform
- Replacement is simple

Cons

- Editor order can mislead creators
- Global priority changes affect many moves
- Less expressive multi-effect moves

**Recommendation:**  
**Option A**

A gives the editor the clearest preview and the replay system the smallest deterministic state space. New status behaviors can still arrive as versioned engine effects.

YOUR CHOICE

NOTES

DECISION 02 • R02 / D05 remainder • M6 Mix runtime

# Mixed-source cooldown penalty

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                        |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>QUESTION</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | How much extra cooldown should each source receive when a mixed move reaches attempted execution?                                                      |
| <b>WHAT IT IS</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                | <b>WHAT IT DOES</b>                                                                                                                                    |
| Every mix engages two base moves. This decision turns that commitment into exact cooldown deadlines and defines the separate ceiling required above the ordinary 3600-tick authoring cap.                                        | It controls how frequently powerful discoveries can be repeated and whether slow source moves become unusable after mixing.                            |
| <b>EFFECT ON THE INITIAL IDEA</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                | <b>DEPENDENCIES</b>                                                                                                                                    |
| Mixing stays a deliberate tactical commitment instead of a free combination button. The player can still tune the whole game's pacing with 30, 60, or 120 ticks, while the penalty remains proportional to the selected sources. | Uses the approved attempted-execution origin, free pre-execution actor cancellation, full-cost invalid-target fizzle, and checked deadline arithmetic. |

## Options

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|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A   Multiplicative 3/2 RECOMMENDED</b>                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Each source receives $\text{ceil}(3 \times \text{ordinary cooldown} / 2)$ . Mixed cooldown begins at attempted mixed execution. The engine permits mixed deadlines up to 5400 ticks and rejects overflow before effects commit. |                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <div>Pros<ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Proportional and easy to calculate</li><li>Always exceeds each legal source cooldown</li><li>Works across the full 60-3600 range</li></ul></div>                                 | <div>Cons<ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Very slow sources can be locked for a long time</li><li>Requires a distinct mix ceiling</li></ul></div>                                    |
| <b>B   Add 60 ticks</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Each source receives ordinary cooldown plus 60 ticks, with a 3660-tick mixed ceiling.                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <div>Pros<ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Simple mental model</li><li>Mild punishment for slow moves</li></ul></div>                                                                                                       | <div>Cons<ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Large relative penalty on fast moves</li><li>Almost irrelevant on slow moves</li><li>Balance changes with pacing selection</li></ul></div> |
| <b>C   Cooldown tiers</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Map the ordinary cooldown into engine tiers, such as +60, +180, +600, or +1800 ticks, then use a tier-specific mixed ceiling.                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <div>Pros<ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Fine balance control</li><li>Can protect extreme values</li></ul></div>                                                                                                          | <div>Cons<ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Harder to communicate</li><li>Boundary cliffs</li><li>More engine constants to maintain</li></ul></div>                                    |
| <b>Recommendation: Option A</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                 | A scales with the authored move and preserves the meaning of cooldown across all three player-selected pacing modes.                                                                      |

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| <b>YOUR CHOICE</b> |  | <b>NOTES</b> |  |
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DECISION 03 • R03 / D06 • M6 Mix progression

# Harmony scale, growth, and battle benefits

|                            |                                                                                                                                                                   |  |  |
|----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|--|
| QUESTION                   | How should individual Harmony grow, what counts as success, and how should it improve a learned mix?                                                              |  |  |
| WHAT IT IS                 | Harmony is a per-monster proficiency for an unlocked recipe. It needs a bounded scale, a growth event, and exact effects on accuracy and critical chance.         |  |  |
| WHAT IT DOES               | It rewards continued use without changing the base species or permanently modifying the recipe for every monster.                                                 |  |  |
| EFFECT ON THE INITIAL IDEA | The original discovery-and-training loop gains long-term ownership: two monsters can know the same mix but perform it differently because their histories differ. |  |  |
| DEPENDENCIES               | Requires the shared 0-10000 probability scale and ordinary critical cap. Witness/training semantics in R06 determine when a recipe first becomes usable.          |  |  |

## Options

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|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A   Linear 0-1000 proficiency RECOMMENDED                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                  |
| Start at 0. After a valid mixed execution that produces at least one intended gameplay effect, add 25 up to 1000. Scale up to +500 accuracy units and +625 critical units linearly; ordinary critical chance still clamps at 2500. |                                                                                                                                  |
| Pros <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Transparent progress</li><li>Exact integer math</li><li>Forty meaningful successes reach the cap</li></ul>                                                                              | Cons <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Steady growth may feel mechanical</li><li>A successful miss gives no growth</li></ul> |
| B   Six mastery tiers                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                  |
| Advance through six thresholds using successful executions. Each tier grants a fixed accuracy and critical package.                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                  |
| Pros <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Clear milestones</li><li>Easy celebratory UI</li></ul>                                                                                                                                  | Cons <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Power jumps at thresholds</li><li>Progress between tiers can feel invisible</li></ul> |
| C   Diminishing lookup curve                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                  |
| Use a bounded table with fast early growth and small late gains; benefits are read from engine-owned breakpoints.                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                  |
| Pros <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Early experimentation feels rewarding</li><li>Long mastery tail</li></ul>                                                                                                               | Cons <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Harder to predict</li><li>More table data and UI explanation</li></ul>                |
| Recommendation: Option A                                                                                                                                                                                                           | A is easy to serialize, display as a percentage, and test exhaustively while keeping bonuses modest and bounded.                 |

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| YOUR CHOICE |  | NOTES |  |
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DECISION 04 • R04 / D07 • M5 Multi-type attacks

# Component allocation and rounding

|                            |                                                                                                                                                                    |  |  |
|----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|--|
| QUESTION                   | How should a move's finite power be divided among two or more type components without losing or inventing power?                                                   |  |  |
| WHAT IT IS                 | A multi-type move resolves a nonempty list of typed components. Allocation decides each component's power before its own STAB, matchup, and other modifiers.       |  |  |
| EFFECT ON THE INITIAL IDEA | The initial idea can support genuinely mixed attacks rather than a cosmetic second label. Creator previews can show the exact component breakdown before playtest. |  |  |
| WHAT IT DOES               | It prevents split-count exploits and fixes deterministic rounding for every 2-, 3-, or 4-component move.                                                           |  |  |
| DEPENDENCIES               | Gates M5 and feeds R05 STAB. Duplicate types remain rejected; zero allocated power remains zero.                                                                   |  |  |

## Options

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| A   Canonical quotient and remainder RECOMMENDED                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Allow 1-4 distinct type components. Divide total power by the component count. Assign the remainder one point at a time in canonical Typeld order, then floor after each component's modifier chain before summing. |                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Pros <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Never loses base power</li><li>Simple integers</li><li>Canonical across content order</li></ul>                                                                          | Cons <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Low Typelds receive the occasional extra point</li><li>Final damage need not equal unsplit damage</li></ul>                     |
| B   Exact rational carry                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Keep every component as an exact rational share through all modifiers and floor only the final aggregate.                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Pros <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Minimal early rounding</li><li>Strong conservation property</li></ul>                                                                                                    | Cons <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>More complex arithmetic bounds</li><li>Harder component-by-component previews</li><li>Less natural component outcomes</li></ul> |
| C   Independent truncation                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Floor total power divided by the component count for every component and discard the remainder.                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Pros <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Very simple</li><li>All components start equal</li></ul>                                                                                                                 | Cons <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Loses authored power</li><li>Extra components can reduce output unexpectedly</li></ul>                                          |
| Recommendation: Option A                                                                                                                                                                                            | A preserves the full integer budget, avoids hidden fractions in runtime state, and has a canonical result independent of author entry order.                               |

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| YOUR CHOICE |  | NOTES |  |
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DECISION 05 • R05 / D08 • M5 Multi-type attacks

# Same-type attack bonus for components

|                            |                                                                                                                                                                                       |  |  |
|----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|--|
| QUESTION                   | When an actor's type matches one component of a multi-type move, where should the same-type bonus apply?                                                                              |  |  |
| WHAT IT IS                 | <div><div>WHAT IT DOES</div><div>It determines whether a partially matching mixed attack receives a focused bonus, a bonus across the whole move, or no mix bonus.</div></div>        |  |  |
| EFFECT ON THE INITIAL IDEA | <div><div>DEPENDENCIES</div><div>Applies after R04 allocation and before final component aggregation. Type changes and duplicate actor types must follow one engine rule.</div></div> |  |  |

## Options

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|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|
| <b>A   Per matching component at 3/2 RECOMMENDED</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                     |       |
| <p>Multiply a component by 3/2 exactly once when any of the actor's distinct current types matches it. Multiple actor-type matches never stack on the same component.</p> <div><div>Pros<ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Local and explainable</li><li>Supports partial specialization</li><li>No duplicate-type stacking</li></ul></div><div>Cons<ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Requires per-component UI</li><li>Mixed totals are less obvious at a glance</li></ul></div></div> |                                                                                                                     |       |
| <b>B   Attack-wide 3/2</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                     |       |
| <p>If any component matches any actor type, apply 3/2 to the final aggregate.</p> <div><div>Pros<ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Simple summary number</li><li>Strong reward for one matching component</li></ul></div><div>Cons<ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Boosts unrelated components</li><li>Encourages token matching components</li></ul></div></div>                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                     |       |
| <b>C   No STAB on mixed attacks</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                     |       |
| <p>Keep 3/2 STAB for ordinary single-type moves and suppress it for every mixed output.</p> <div><div>Pros<ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Mix balance is isolated</li><li>Few calculations</li></ul></div><div>Cons<ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Actor typing matters less during the signature system</li><li>Mixed attacks may feel detached from their users</li></ul></div></div>                                                                                            |                                                                                                                     |       |
| Recommendation: Option A                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | A keeps the bonus local to the matching damage and prevents one matching component from amplifying unrelated types. |       |
| YOUR CHOICE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                     | NOTES |

DECISION 06 • R06 / D09 remainder • M6 Discovery and training

# Witnesses, training access, and outcome commits

|                            |                                                                                                                                                                     |              |                                                                                                                                     |
|----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| QUESTION                   | Who observes a mix, when is it recorded, and what must happen before that observer can use it?                                                                      |              |                                                                                                                                     |
| WHAT IT IS                 | Observation is persistent knowledge; training converts observed knowledge into an unlocked recipe. Retained history after forgetting is already approved.           | WHAT IT DOES | This sets discovery difficulty, whether enemies teach the player, and whether a lost or escaped battle can still advance knowledge. |
| EFFECT ON THE INITIAL IDEA | The original idea's learn-by-seeing system becomes a concrete adventure loop: witness in battle, return to a service, invest a resource, then practice for Harmony. | DEPENDENCIES | Uses unordered distinct source pairs and retained history. Must define same-action KO ordering and battle-result merge behavior.    |

## Options

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|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|-----------------------------------------------|
| A   Active conscious witness plus facility training RECOMMENDED                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                               |      |                                               |
| An active conscious combatant that knows both sources observes any valid mix execution, including a miss but excluding cancellation/fizzle. Allies and enemies qualify. Merge observation at terminal battle results, including loss and escape. Unlock at a designated trainer by paying one bounded training token while both sources are known. |                                                                                                                               |      |                                               |
| Pros                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | • Strong connection between battle and world                                                                                  | Cons | • Requires trainer access and a token economy |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | • Losses can still teach                                                                                                      |      | • Benched party members do not learn          |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | • Costs and requirements are explicit                                                                                         |      |                                               |
| B   Whole conscious party and automatic unlock                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                               |      |                                               |
| Every conscious owned party member that knows both sources observes and immediately unlocks the recipe after the battle, with no separate cost.                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                               |      |                                               |
| Pros                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                               | Cons | • Training feature largely disappears         |
| • Low friction                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                               |      | • Knowledge spreads quickly                   |
| • Party-wide experimentation                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                               |      | • Enemy witnessing is asymmetric              |
| C   All-owned observation plus field training                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                               |      |                                               |
| Every owned monster that knows both sources receives observation remotely; the player may spend a training item anywhere outside battle to unlock it.                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                               |      |                                               |
| Pros                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                               | Cons | • Weakens the meaning of witnessing           |
| • Convenient roster management                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                               |      | • Large fan-out updates                       |
| • No travel requirement                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                               |      | • Harder fiction to explain                   |
| Recommendation: Option A                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | A keeps discovery earned in combat and training as a clear world activity, while preserving knowledge from difficult battles. |      |                                               |

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| YOUR CHOICE |  | NOTES |  |
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DECISION 07 • R07 / D11 • M7 Progression

Level 1-200 XP, stats, and evolution

|                            |                                                                                                                                                                       |  |  |
|----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|--|
| QUESTION                   | Which engine-owned progression structure should scale safely through level 200?                                                                                       |  |  |
| WHAT IT IS                 | Progression needs monotone XP thresholds, bounded integer stat functions, evolution triggers, HP adjustment rules, move-learning behavior, and reward distribution.   |  |  |
| EFFECT ON THE INITIAL IDEA | The maker can author species growth parameters and evolution conditions inside safe ranges, while the engine guarantees that every level from 1 through 200 is valid. |  |  |
| WHAT IT DOES               | It controls the campaign's length and makes sure late-game values stay inside the approved 1-9999 effective-stat range.                                               |  |  |
| DEPENDENCIES               | Consumes M4 combat bounds and gates capture/party integration in M7. Exact tables still require balance playtesting after the structural choice.                      |  |  |

Options

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                               |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A   Explicit monotone thresholds RECOMMENDED                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                               |
| Ship an engine-owned 200-entry cumulative XP table and bounded integer stat tables/functions validated at every level. Cap stored XP at the level-200 threshold. Evolution uses explicit level/item/event predicates; level-up HP increases by the max-HP delta. |                                                                                                                                                               |
| Pros <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Fully auditable</li><li>No overflow surprises</li><li>Easy boundary tests</li></ul>                                                                                                                                   | Cons <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Large table to balance</li><li>Curve changes require a ruleset version</li></ul>                                   |
| B   Single polynomial family                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                               |
| Use one checked polynomial XP curve and one formula family for stats across levels 1-200.                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                               |
| Pros <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Compact implementation</li><li>Smooth mathematical curve</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                    | Cons <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Harder to tune locally</li><li>Late-level growth can dominate</li><li>Formula mistakes have broad impact</li></ul> |
| C   Segmented curves                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                               |
| Use separate early, middle, late, and endgame formulas joined at fixed breakpoints.                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                               |
| Pros <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Strong pacing control by campaign phase</li><li>Fewer entries than a full table</li></ul>                                                                                                                             | Cons <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Breakpoint cliffs</li><li>More formula branches</li><li>Harder creator explanation</li></ul>                       |
| Recommendation: Option A                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | A makes every threshold inspectable and allows balance changes through a versioned engine table without risking polynomial overflow.                          |

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| YOUR CHOICE |  | NOTES |  |
|-------------|--|-------|--|

DECISION 08 • R08 / D12 • M7 Capture

# Capture action, eligibility, and destination

|                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                   |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>QUESTION</b>                                                                                                                                                  | How should capture consume time and inventory while preventing duplication and full-roster loss?                                                  |
| <b>WHAT IT IS</b>                                                                                                                                                | <b>WHAT IT DOES</b>                                                                                                                               |
| Capture is an atomic transaction that may consume an action and item, test a bounded probability, create one owned individual, and route it to party or storage. | It fixes failure costs, trainer restrictions, destination checks, and what happens when the roster is full.                                       |
| <b>EFFECT ON THE INITIAL IDEA</b>                                                                                                                                | <b>DEPENDENCIES</b>                                                                                                                               |
| The demo promise of catching monsters becomes a normal battle tactic and connects battles to party building and the maker's encounter content.                   | Uses the shared probability scale and needs R09 capacity values. Battle completion and escape results remain preserved as distinct core outcomes. |

## Options

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| <b>A   Action, item, and bounded probability RECOMMENDED</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Capture is a battle action using one eligible item. Reject before consumption when the target is restricted or neither party nor storage has a legal destination. On attempted execution, consume the item; failure spends the turn. Success atomically creates one individual and routes party first, then storage. |                                                                                                                                                                               |
| <div>Pros<ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Tactical and familiar</li><li>Atomic ownership</li><li>Capacity failure is safe</li></ul></div>                                                                                                                                                                       | <div>Cons<ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Needs a tuned formula</li><li>Random failure can frustrate</li></ul></div>                                                     |
| <b>B   Deterministic condition threshold</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Capture succeeds whenever visible target-state conditions meet an engine threshold; the item and action are consumed only on success.                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                               |
| <div>Pros<ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>No bad-luck streaks</li><li>Clear planning</li></ul></div>                                                                                                                                                                                                            | <div>Cons<ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Can become a solved checklist</li><li>Less item tension</li><li>Threshold UI must be exact</li></ul></div>                     |
| <b>C   Scripted encounters only</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Only designated encounters expose a deterministic capture command; ordinary battles never allow capture.                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                               |
| <div>Pros<ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Simple balance and story control</li><li>Small exploit surface</li></ul></div>                                                                                                                                                                                        | <div>Cons<ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Weakens collection freedom</li><li>More authoring work</li><li>Does not fulfill free-form catching as strongly</li></ul></div> |
| <b>Recommendation: Option A</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | A provides tactical risk and collection progression while an upfront destination check prevents item loss or duplicate individuals.                                           |
| <b>YOUR CHOICE</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | <b>NOTES</b>                                                                                                                                                                  |

DECISION 09 • R09 / D13 • M7 Economy and roster

# Party, storage, move, inventory, and currency caps

|                            |                                                                                                                                                         |  |  |
|----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|--|
| QUESTION                   | Which capacity model should define valid saves, rewards, transfers, and shop transactions?                                                              |  |  |
| WHAT IT IS                 | This group sets engine-owned limits and atomic over-cap behavior for party members, stored monsters, learned/equipped moves, item stacks, and currency. |  |  |
| WHAT IT DOES               | It prevents partial rewards and makes every inventory, buy/sell, capture, and party transfer result predictable.                                        |  |  |
| EFFECT ON THE INITIAL IDEA | The maker UI can validate content against the same limits the game uses, and the player gets a compact party and readable command set.                  |  |  |
| DEPENDENCIES               | Feeds R08 capture, M8 world rewards, M10 editor panels, and M11 save bounds.                                                                            |  |  |

## Options

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |  |                                                                                                                                                              |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A   Fixed bounded capacities RECOMMENDED                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |  |                                                                                                                                                              |
| Set party size 6, equipped move slots 4, storage 1000 individuals, item stacks 999, distinct inventory entries 512, and currency 9,999,999. Reject transactions that cannot fit; route eligible captures party-first then storage; never grant partially. |  |                                                                                                                                                              |
| Pros <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Simple UI and saves</li><li>Easy validation</li><li>Predictable atomic transactions</li></ul>                                                                                                                  |  | Cons <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Large projects may hit fixed ceilings</li><li>Exact values become compatibility rules</li></ul>                   |
| B   Engine-tiered unlocks                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |  |                                                                                                                                                              |
| Start with smaller limits and let engine-defined upgrades expand party-adjacent storage, inventory, or stack caps within a fixed maximum.                                                                                                                 |  |                                                                                                                                                              |
| Pros <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Capacity can support progression</li><li>Early UI stays compact</li></ul>                                                                                                                                      |  | Cons <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>More save state and economy balance</li><li>Upgrade timing can block rewards</li></ul>                            |
| C   Mostly unbounded storage                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |  |                                                                                                                                                              |
| Keep party and equipped moves bounded, but allow storage and inventory collections to grow until a broad technical resource cap.                                                                                                                          |  |                                                                                                                                                              |
| Pros <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Few player-facing capacity blocks</li><li>Supports very large catalogs</li></ul>                                                                                                                               |  | Cons <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Harder performance guarantees</li><li>Save/UI growth</li><li>Technical caps feel arbitrary when reached</li></ul> |
| Recommendation: Option A                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |  | A gives every subsystem exact limits now. Larger projects can receive versioned increases later after performance evidence.                                  |
| YOUR CHOICE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |  | NOTES                                                                                                                                                        |

DECISION 10 • R10 / D14 • M8 Overworld

# World grid, movement, encounters, and conflicts

|                            |                                                                                                                                                                          |  |  |
|----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|--|
| QUESTION                   | What authoritative geometry and step semantics should drive exploration?                                                                                                 |  |  |
| WHAT IT IS                 | The world model determines traversable cells, elevation, ramps, actor conflicts, interactions, transitions, and when encounter RNG is sampled.                           |  |  |
| EFFECT ON THE INITIAL IDEA | The maker keeps tile-oriented authoring while the finished game can present depth, billboards, slopes, and smooth motion. Player pacing remains consistent and testable. |  |  |
| WHAT IT DOES               | It separates logical movement from visual interpolation so 2.5D rendering never changes game state.                                                                      |  |  |
| DEPENDENCIES               | Builds on M2 content, M3 deterministic time, and M7 party state. Gates renderer integration and the end-to-end maker playtest.                                           |  |  |

## Options

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                        |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A   Four-direction tile grid RECOMMENDED</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                        |
| Use integer x/y/elevation cells, four-direction authoritative moves, and explicit ramp/transition links. Resolve one move atomically; sample encounters once after entering an eligible cell. Actor conflicts use stable ActorId priority; interactions target the adjacent facing cell. |                                                                                                                                                        |
| Pros <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Clear editor tools</li><li>Deterministic pathing</li><li>Strong 2.5D separation</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                     | Cons <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>No diagonal shortcuts</li><li>Curved spaces need visual decoration</li></ul>                                |
| <b>B   Eight-direction tile grid</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                        |
| Use the same cell/elevation model but permit diagonals with explicit corner-blocking rules and diagonal interaction targets.                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                        |
| Pros <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>More fluid routes</li><li>Still tile authored</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                       | Cons <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>More collision and animation cases</li><li>Diagonal distance and encounters need extra rules</li></ul>      |
| <b>C   Navigation grid over tile art</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                        |
| Creators paint tiles but traversal uses a finer navigation grid and explicit links.                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                        |
| Pros <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>More natural movement shapes</li><li>Visual tiles need not equal movement cells</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                     | Cons <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Harder maker UX</li><li>More pathfinding state</li><li>Less direct map-to-replay correspondence</li></ul>   |
| <b>Recommendation: Option A</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | A is the easiest to author, preview, replay, and validate. Explicit links cover stairs, ramps, doors, and elevation changes without free-form physics. |

|             |       |
|-------------|-------|
| YOUR CHOICE | NOTES |
|-------------|-------|

DECISION 11 • R11 / D15 • M2 contracts / M10 Maker

# Catalog editing powers and engine authority

|                            |                                                                                                                                                                        |  |  |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|--|
| QUESTION                   | Which catalog fields may projects author, and which identities and formulas stay engine owned?                                                                         |  |  |
| WHAT IT IS                 | This is the security and compatibility boundary between project data and the executable ruleset.                                                                       |  |  |
| WHAT IT DOES               | It decides whether creators can add species, moves, items, and recipes safely without redefining type math, status code, abilities, or formulas.                       |  |  |
| EFFECT ON THE INITIAL IDEA | The original no-code RPG maker stays expressive in content while preserving deterministic behavior, portable saves, and projects that cannot smuggle executable logic. |  |  |
| DEPENDENCIES               | Controls schemas, validation, M4 effects, M5 types, M10 inspectors, and M11 content identity.                                                                          |  |  |

## Options

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |  |                                                                                                                                                                 |  |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|
| A   Bounded creator catalogs RECOMMENDED                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |  |                                                                                                                                                                 |  |
| Projects may add bounded species, trainers, encounters, maps, dialogue, items, moves, and unordered mix recipes. They select engine-defined types, targets, effects, statuses, and abilities. Type registry/chart, formulas, opcodes, and effect semantics change only with an engine release. |  |                                                                                                                                                                 |  |
| Pros                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |  | Cons                                                                                                                                                            |  |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Strong maker freedom</li><li>• No project code</li><li>• Stable validation and replay</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                        |  | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• New mechanics require engine updates</li><li>• Field matrix must be documented carefully</li></ul>                      |  |
| B   Fixed official catalogs                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |  |                                                                                                                                                                 |  |
| Projects may arrange encounters, maps, and dialogue but cannot add species, moves, items, or recipes.                                                                                                                                                                                          |  |                                                                                                                                                                 |  |
| Pros                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |  | Cons                                                                                                                                                            |  |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Smallest compatibility surface</li><li>• Simplest content support</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                            |  | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Falls short of a full monster RPG maker</li><li>• Low creator identity</li></ul>                                        |  |
| C   Reviewed extension packs                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |  |                                                                                                                                                                 |  |
| Base projects use bounded catalogs, while signed trusted packs may add types and effect definitions after review.                                                                                                                                                                              |  |                                                                                                                                                                 |  |
| Pros                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |  | Cons                                                                                                                                                            |  |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Supports major expansions</li><li>• Can grow mechanics without core releases</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                 |  | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Introduces a trust/distribution system</li><li>• Fragmented compatibility</li><li>• Review and signing burden</li></ul> |  |
| Recommendation: Option A                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |  | A matches the project brief: broad bounded content authoring with a small, reviewable engine language.                                                          |  |
| YOUR CHOICE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |  | NOTES                                                                                                                                                           |  |

DECISION 12 • R12 / D16 • M2 validation / M8 events

# Event graphs and cumulative content budgets

|                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                           |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>QUESTION</b>                                                                                                                                                                     | How should finite event opcodes remain bounded when maps, triggers, dialogue, and persistent state interact?                                              |
| <b>WHAT IT IS</b>                                                                                                                                                                   | <b>WHAT IT DOES</b>                                                                                                                                       |
| Even without creator code, event graphs can loop or fan out. The engine needs structural rules and cumulative limits for steps, queue size, nesting, entities, files, and payloads. | It guarantees that a valid project cannot hang the game or grow memory indefinitely, and that failures produce deterministic diagnostics.                 |
| <b>EFFECT ON THE INITIAL IDEA</b>                                                                                                                                                   | <b>DEPENDENCIES</b>                                                                                                                                       |
| The maker can support quests, switches, dialogue, transitions, and long-running stories while remaining safe for offline packages and replayable tests.                             | Feeds loader validation, M8 event runtime, M10 diagnostics, packaging, and hardening. Numeric budgets should be calibrated from measured sample projects. |

## Options

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A   Acyclic immediate graph RECOMMENDED</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Require the graph reached by one activation to be acyclic. Model repetition as persistent state and later activations. Enforce cumulative fuel, queue, depth, entity, and byte caps across yields; exhaustion aborts the activation atomically with a deterministic diagnostic. |                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <div>Pros</div> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Strong termination proof</li><li>Clear editor cycle errors</li><li>Persistent quests still work</li></ul>                                                                                                                 | <div>Cons</div> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Some loop-like scenes require state-machine authoring</li><li>Budgets still need measurement</li></ul>                            |
| <b>B   Cycles with global fuel</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Allow arbitrary graph cycles but decrement one global step budget until completion or deterministic exhaustion.                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <div>Pros</div> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Flexible graphs</li><li>Simple runtime guard</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                    | <div>Cons</div> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Creators can ship scenes that always exhaust</li><li>Harder preview and debugging</li><li>Termination is not structural</li></ul> |
| <b>C   Bounded structured loops</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Disallow graph back-edges except explicit repeat nodes with an authored count under an engine maximum.                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <div>Pros</div> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Supports compact repeated scenes</li><li>Bound is visible</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                       | <div>Cons</div> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Adds an event-language construct</li><li>Nested loop accounting is more complex</li></ul>                                         |
| <b>Recommendation: Option A</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | A prevents same-activation cycles by construction and still supports ongoing quests through explicit persistent state between activations.                                              |
| <b>YOUR CHOICE</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | <b>NOTES</b>                                                                                                                                                                            |

DECISION 13 • R13 / D17 • M1 contracts / M11 release

# Save, replay, migration, and battle-save compatibility

|                            |                                                                                                                                                                                       |  |  |
|----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|--|
| QUESTION                   | What identity must match before loading deterministic state, and where may the game save initially?                                                                                   |  |  |
| WHAT IT IS                 | Saves and replays must identify the engine ruleset and project content that gives every ID and formula meaning. Migration rules decide whether older data is transformed or rejected. |  |  |
| EFFECT ON THE INITIAL IDEA | The project can promise dependable offline saves and exact replays early. Mid-battle saving can arrive later when the full battle machine is serialized and proven.                   |  |  |
| WHAT IT DOES               | It prevents silent reinterpretation, broken replays, and partial mid-battle state that cannot restore queues, reservations, RNG, or pending commits.                                  |  |  |
| DEPENDENCIES               | Touches every milestone, especially content identity, accepted command logs, packaging, copy-to-clean-install tests, and future engine upgrades.                                      |  |  |

## Options

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |  |                                                                                                                              |  |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|
| <div>A   Exact identity and stable-boundary saves RECOMMENDED</div> <div>Require exact ruleset version and project content digest. Save initially only at stable world boundaries, outside active battle/event transactions. Replays store full initial state plus accepted commands. Add explicit schema-only migrations later; never reinterpret across rulesets.</div> <div><div>Pros<ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Strong deterministic guarantees</li><li>Small initial save surface</li><li>Clear mismatch errors</li></ul></div><div>Cons<ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>No initial mid-battle saves</li><li>Content edits invalidate old saves unless migrated</li></ul></div></div> |  |                                                                                                                              |  |
| <div>B   Declared compatible ranges</div> <div>Let engine and projects declare compatible version ranges; load when schemas and identifiers appear compatible, applying default values for additions.</div> <div><div>Pros<ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>More saves survive updates</li><li>Less migration authoring</li></ul></div><div>Cons<ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Semantic drift can evade schema checks</li><li>Replay equality becomes harder to guarantee</li></ul></div></div>                                                                                                                                                                                                |  |                                                                                                                              |  |
| <div>C   Mid-battle-first full serialization</div> <div>Serialize the full scheduler, barriers, reservations, RNG, queued events, and pending atomic actions from the first release, while still requiring exact identity.</div> <div><div>Pros<ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Save anywhere</li><li>Strong player convenience</li></ul></div><div>Cons<ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Large early implementation and test burden</li><li>Every battle change expands compatibility work</li></ul></div></div>                                                                                                                                                                                |  |                                                                                                                              |  |
| <div>Recommendation:<br/>Option A</div>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |  | <div>A creates the safest first release contract and keeps future migrations explicit, testable, and version specific.</div> |  |
| <div>YOUR CHOICE</div>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |  | <div>NOTES</div>                                                                                                             |  |

AFTER YOU FILL THE CSV

# Turning choices into implementation rules

Return the completed CSV. Each selected package can then be copied into the owner decision register, expanded into exact laws and schemas, and implemented in milestone order. Notes that alter a package should be resolved before coding that dependent milestone.

|                    |                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|--------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| APPROVAL<br>RECORD | For each accepted row, record the date, selected option, any modified constant, the affected D-number, and the ruleset/law IDs. Silence or an unchanged recommendation is not approval. |
|--------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

|                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PROJECT SOURCES | Prepared from docs/DECISIONS.md, docs/RULES.md, docs/mechanics/BATTLE.md, docs/architecture/DETERMINISM.md, and PLAN.md in the project workspace. Existing approved M3 decisions are treated as fixed dependencies. |
|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

Thirteen groups remain in this packet.